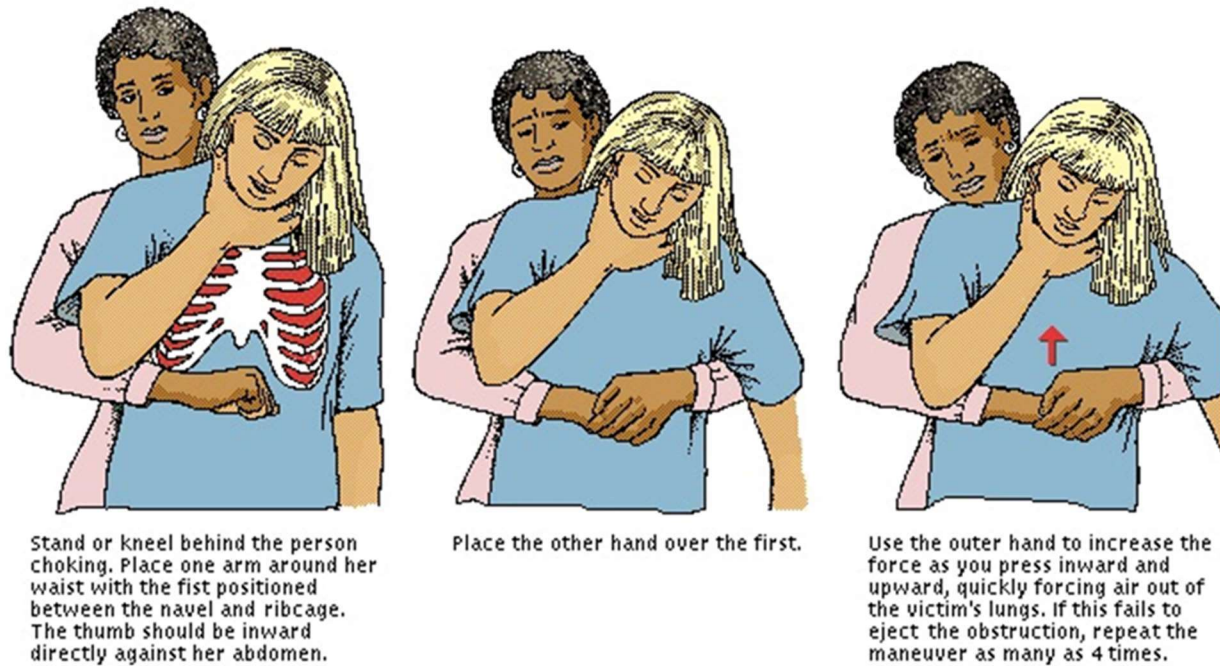


CHOKING



If a person is choking, you shouldn't get in the way as long as they're coughing. If coughing doesn't remove the object and the person is breathing with extreme difficulty, turning a bluish color, and is unable to cough or speak, quickly ask, "Are you choking?"

A choking person can nod their head "yes" but will be unable to talk.

Here's what you'll do:

- Stand behind the person with your arms at the waist.
- Place one fist, with the knuckle of the thumb against the person's midsection, slightly above the navel but well below the breastbone.
- Hold your fist firmly with the other hand and pull both hands sharply yourself with an upward and inward jab. This is called the Heimlich Maneuver.
- This procedure should be done until the object is forced out or the victim becomes unconscious.
- If the victim becomes unconscious, help them to the ground and get help right away.

CHOKING CHILD

Young children especially are prone to choking. A child may choke on food, or may put small objects into her mouth and cause a blockage of the airway. If a child is choking, you need to act quickly. If she loses consciousness, the throat muscles may relax and the airway may open enough to do rescue breathing. Be prepared to begin rescue breaths and chest compressions.

What to do

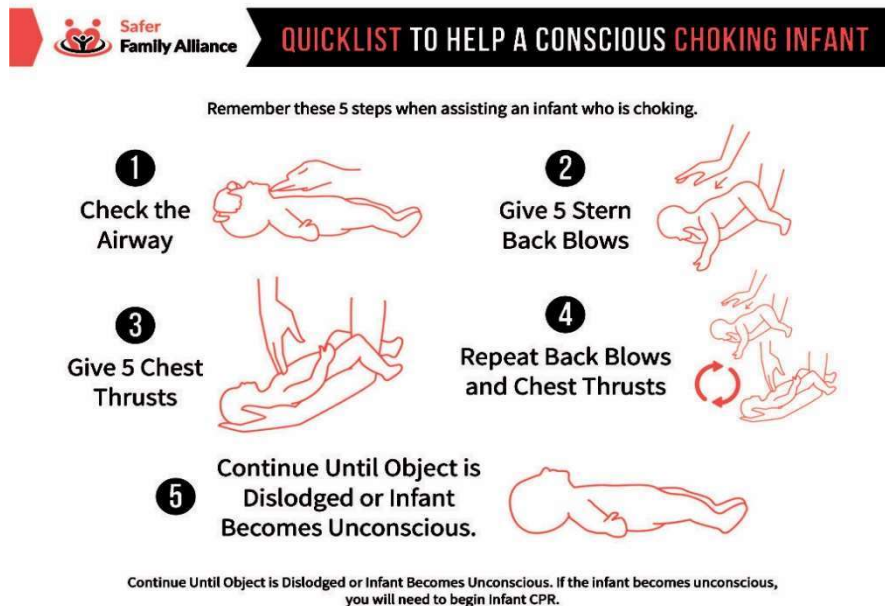
- If the child is breathing, encourage her to continue coughing. If she is not coughing and not able to breathe, she is choking. Go to step 2.
- Put your arms around the child's upper abdomen. Place your fist between the navel and the bottom of her breastbone, and grasp it with your other hand. Pull sharply inward and upward until the object is dislodged or the child becomes unconscious.



- If the child becomes unresponsive, carefully support her to the ground and start CPR with chest compressions. After 30 compressions, open the airway and look in her mouth. If a foreign body is seen, remove it but do not perform blind finger sweeps. Then attempt to give two breaths and continue with cycles of chest compressions and ventilations until the object is expelled.
- After two minutes, if no one has already done so, the obstruction still has not cleared or the child has not regained consciousness, call for emergency help. Then continue CPR until help arrives.

CHOKING INFANT (UNDER ONE YEAR)

An infant is more likely to choke on food or small objects than an adult. The infant will rapidly become distressed, and you need to act quickly to clear any obstruction. If the infant loses consciousness, the throat muscles may relax and the airway may open enough to do rescue breathing. Be prepared to begin chest compressions and rescue breaths.



Step 1- If the infant is distressed, is unable to cry, cough, or breathe, lay him face down along your forearm, with his head low, and support his back and head (**Stage 2**). Give up to five back blows, with the heel of your hand.

Step 2- If back blows fail to clear the obstruction, turn the infant onto his back and give chest compressions (**Stage 3**). Using two fingers, push against the infant's breastbone, in the nipple line.

Step 3- Perform up to five chest compressions. The aim is to relieve the obstruction with each chest compression rather than necessarily doing all five.

Step 4- Check the infant's mouth; remove any obvious obstructions with your fingertips. Do not sweep the mouth with your finger because this may push the object farther down the throat.

Repeat steps 1–4 until the object clears or the infant loses consciousness.

- If the obstruction has not cleared and he becomes unconscious, call for emergency help, then start CPR with chest compressions. Continue until help arrives.

FIT AND/OR EPILEPTIC SEIZURE (CONVULSIONS)

Convulsions are seizures or fits that cause loss of consciousness and a jerking movement of muscles. They are caused by changes in the normal nerve impulses to and from the brain. High fever, certain medications, injury to the head, infection of spinal fluid or fluid surrounding the brain, or a tumor in the spine or brain all could result in seizures.

What you need to know

Convulsions can be frightening, especially if you have not seen them before. They will stop on their own after a few seconds or minutes.

- The person cries or moans, then loses consciousness.
- The eyes stare blankly or roll back.
- There may be sudden loss of control of bladder and bowels.
- Jerking movements of the body, especially the arms and legs, occurs.
- The seizure may involve the whole body or just one part.
- If there is a possibility of a convulsion, the doctor may order a medication to help prevent it.